



JYOTHI YARRAJI (ABOVE) CLOCKED 13.16 IN HER HEATS TO FINISH LAST AND THEN FINISHED FOURTH IN REPECHAGE. KIRAN PAHAL (BELOW) FINISHED SEVENTH IN HEATS AND LAST IN REPECHAGE

competition in Panchkula a little over a month ago, was close to two seconds off that pace in both the heats (52.51), where she finished seventh, and in the repechage competition (52.59), where she finished last.

Jyothi Yarraji, who had regularly clocked sub-13-second timings over the last couple of years, fell outside that 13-second barrier in Paris. She clocked 13.16 in her heats to finish last and then finished fourth in her repechage heat. Had she matched her personal best (12.78) in either race, she would have qualified for the next round.

These sub-par performances will leave the Indian federation with plenty to think about.

Following his competition, Neeraj said he will likely undergo surgery to treat the groin condition that has been bothering him.

For now, it seems India's hopes and dreams for the 2028 Olympics will depend on the success of the procedure.

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